IMPACT ANALYSIS

Determining Who and What Is Affected and the Business Consequence

AGENDA

01 **Objective**
Determine scope of impact and business consequence

02 **Assessment Criteria**
Users, services, scope, SLA, and customer exposure

03 **Impact Levels**
High, Medium, and Low classification with thresholds

04 **Impact by the Numbers**
Industry data — incident frequency and service breakdown

05 **Real-World Examples**
Payment gateway, reporting tools, and test environments

06 **Cost of Downtime**
Financial impact benchmarks by industry

07 **Documentation & CMDB**
Incident records, CI linkage, and closure requirements

08 **Impact Assessment Matrix**
Scenario-based severity and SLA mapping

OBJECTIVE

Determine who and what is affected and the business consequence.

1

Identify Stakeholders

Determine all affected users, teams, customers and business units

2

Assess Business Impact

Evaluate revenue loss, SLA breaches and service degradation

3

Drive Resolution Priority

Assign incident severity and guide escalation and recovery plans

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

Number of Users Impacted

Volume of affected end-users (internal staff, customers, partners)

Criteria 1

Business Services Affected

Critical services: billing, trading, customer portal, payments

Criteria 2

Geographic Scope

Single site, regional, or global footprint of the incident

Criteria 3

Customer-Facing vs Internal

External customer impact vs internal productivity disruption

Criteria 4

SLA Commitments

24/7 critical vs office-hours vs best-effort service tiers

Criteria 5

IMPACT LEVELS

High Impact

HIGH

Revenue-generating or customer-facing outage with significant business and financial consequences

- Immediate executive escalation
- P1 SLA applies — 4hr resolution target
- War-room incident response activated
- Customer communications required

Medium Impact

MED

Degraded service or internal productivity loss affecting teams without immediate revenue impact

- Team lead notification required
- P2 SLA — 8hr resolution target
- Workaround to be documented
- Monitor for escalation to High

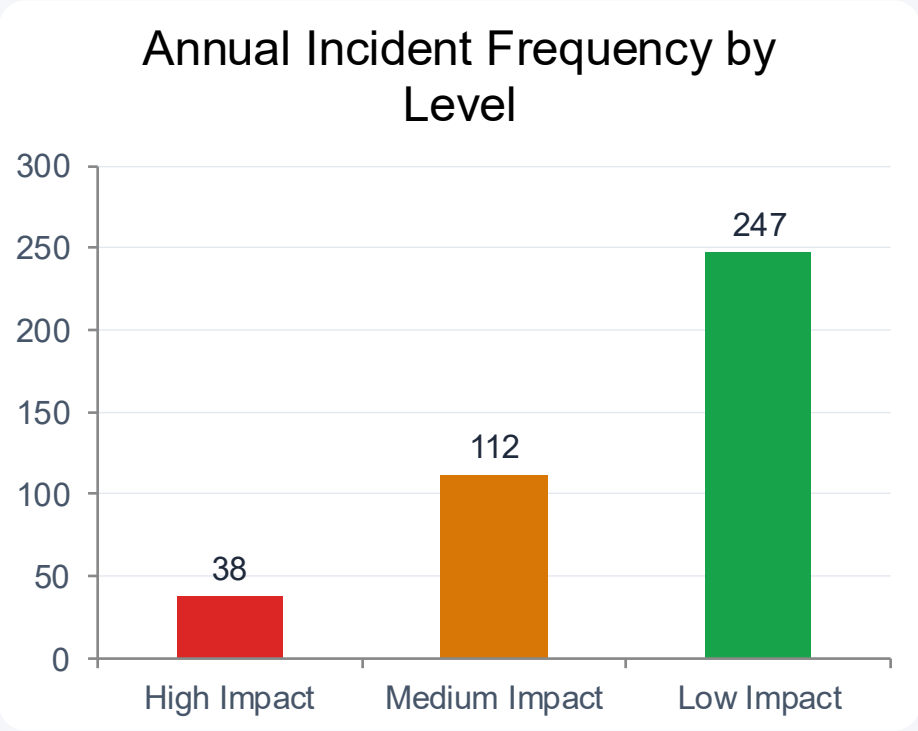
Low Impact

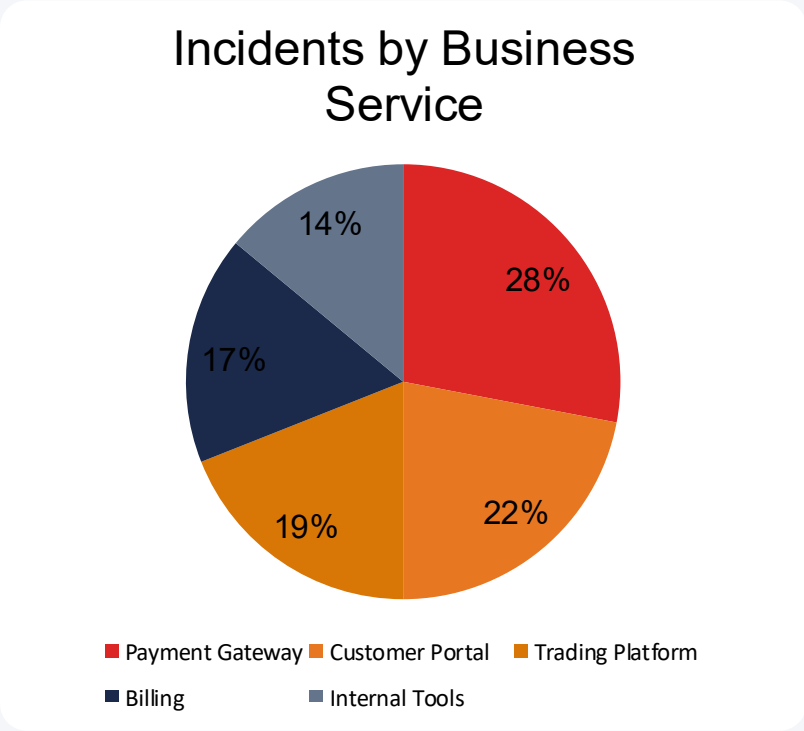
LOW

Minor issues with a viable workaround available; no significant disruption to business operations

- Standard ticket process
- P3 SLA — next business day
- Workaround communicated
- Log and schedule fix

IMPACT BY THE NUMBERS





REAL-WORLD EXAMPLES

HIGH	**Core payment gateway down** Impact: Revenue loss estimated at $50,000–$200,000/hr. Customers unable to complete purchases. **Action: Immediate P1 escalation, executive notification, vendor war-room.**
MEDIUM	**Internal reporting tool running slow** Impact: Analyst productivity impacted. Reports delayed. No customer-facing impact. **Action: P2 ticket raised. Workaround via export to local Excel provided.**
LOW	**Non-critical test environment offline** Impact: QA testing delayed. No production or customer impact whatsoever. **Action: P3 ticket logged. Scheduled restart during next maintenance window.**

DOCUMENTATION & CMDB INTEGRATION

Documentation Checklist

- Update incident record with impacted services and user groups
- Document number of users affected (internal + external)
- Record geographic scope and business region affected
- Specify SLA tier and breach risk level
- Link to affected CI (Configuration Item) in CMDB
- Capture workaround steps if impact is Low/Medium
- Log timeline: detection → triage → resolution

CMDB Linkage

CI Type	Example
Server	*prod-web-01*
Application	*PaymentGW_v3*
Network Device	*fw-core-ny*
Database	*oracle-billing*
Service	*CustomerPortal*

IMPACT ASSESSMENT MATRIX

Scenario	Users Impacted	Scope	Customer-Facing	Level	SLA Target
Payment gateway down	10,000+	Global	✅ Yes	HIGH	4 Hours
Trading platform latency	2,500	Regional	✅ Yes	HIGH	4 Hours
Billing service errors	800	Global	✅ Yes	MEDIUM	8 Hours
Reporting tool slow	150	Single Site	❌ No	MEDIUM	8 Hours
Test env offline	12	Single Site	❌ No	LOW	Next Day